

a Agreement $\neq$ terminality

the real probe stream of one trajectory

The answer is still moving.

Stopping on agreement destroys a recovery the trajectory would have made on its own.

10 × "37" ✗ "46" ✓ to the end



consensus fires at 256, on "37"

harm : rescue $\approx$ 45 : 1

can any
rule be
safe and
saving?

b 3,520 rules, gates fixed in advance

preregistered sweep on frozen trajectories

18 frozen environments

2 models $\times$ 3 benchmarks $\times$ 3 seeds



3,520

consensus rules

three preregistered gates

Ⓒ drop $\leq$ 1.0 pp saving $\geq$ 10%

Ⓑ drop $\leq$ 2.0 pp saving $\geq$ 20%

Ⓓ drop $\leq$ 3.5 pp saving $\geq$ 30%

is early
exit itself
impossible?

0 / 3,520 clear any gate

c The failure is the signal

identical pipeline, gates and accounting

consensus

do recent probes
agree?

DEER

confident at a
reasoning boundary?

same sweep · same gates · same
accounting

✗ consensus 0 of 3 gates

✓ DEER 3 of 3 gates
−0.3 pp accuracy @ 28% tokens saved

Early exit is possible — the consensus **signal** is what cannot make it safe.